



— RELOCATION GUIDE

Palmerston North

Te Papaioea

A relocation guide for healthcare professionals and their families. The work, the neighbourhoods, the money and the weekends in Palmerston North.

Ten minutes to work. Mountains on the horizon.

Palmerston North is the flat, green, friendly city at the crossroads of the lower North Island: a university town with a base hospital, among the best-value housing in the North Island, and mountains on the horizon from almost every street. It is often a city people discover rather than plan for, and the one they most often thank us for afterwards.

~90,000

people in the city

~ 10 min

typical commute to the hospital

1 hr 50

by road to Wellington

1 of a few

NZ centres delivering radiation oncology

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Guides describe places, not employers. Hospitals are described rather than named, and salaries, visas and registration rules change, so we confirm the detail with you directly.

Why clinicians choose Palmerston North

Clinicians often choose Palmerston North on the numbers, then stay for the warmth of the people and the life the city makes room for.



If you are looking for big-city chic or glamour, Palmy is not that. But if you are drawn to warm people, close-knit communities and one of New Zealand's most advanced hospitals outside the three main cities, Palmy could be a great choice.

Palmerston North sits in the middle of the Manawatū plain, about an hour and fifty minutes north of Wellington, with the Tararua and Ruahine ranges rising to the east and thirty kilometres of dune coast to the west. It is a city of around ninety thousand people, built almost entirely on the flat.

Two things shape it. The first is Massey University, whose main campus sits just south of the river and gives the city a young, international, research-minded character. The second is the hospital: the base hospital for the wider region, and one of a small number of centres in the country delivering radiation oncology.

Clinical pay in New Zealand is set nationally. A nurse, radiation therapist, physiotherapist or sonographer on a given step earns exactly the same here as in Auckland or Tauranga. What changes is what the money buys, and here it buys the most.

WHAT YOU GAIN

A home on one salary

A three or four-bedroom family home with a garden, ten minutes from work and in a decent school zone, is an ordinary purchase on a single clinical income.

Hours back

A commute in single-figure minutes and easy parking. Over a year it quietly returns you a working week.

Work bigger than the city

A base hospital with a regional cancer centre, and the visibility that comes with a mid-sized service.

GOOD TO KNOW

A relaxed pace

Palmy is green, friendly and easy-going, with time left over for family and friends. For a big-city night out, Wellington is under two hours away.

A wild coast

The coast half an hour west is dune country and black sand, made for long walks and summer swims. For a classic beach holiday, Hawke's Bay and Taranaki are an easy weekend away.

Tertiary referrals

The most complex work, such as neurosurgery and cardiothoracics, is referred to Wellington, under two hours south.

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Weighing up your options?

People often compare Palmerston North with Wellington, an hour and fifty minutes south, for its arts scene; Waikato, for similar value and a tertiary hospital; and Hawke's Bay or Bay of Plenty, for warmer, beachier summers. Palmy usually offers the most home for your salary. We are happy to talk any of them through.



Weekends with friends: many of the clinicians we move here find their people quickly



A church celebration in Palmerston North: faith and community groups are a warm way in

A flat city between mountains and sea

A flat city in the middle of a river plain, with a mountain range twenty-five minutes east and a wild dune coast half an hour west. The geography explains the wind, the cycling and how easy everything is to reach.

The Manawatū River comes down through the ranges and out across a wide alluvial plain to the Tasman. Palmerston North sits on that plain, just south of the river, laid out on a grid around a central square. There are almost no hills in the city; the only real rise is on the southern edge towards Aokautere and Massey.

East, the Tararua and Ruahine ranges wall off the Wairarapa and Hawke's Bay, split by the Manawatū Gorge, Te Āpiti. West, the plain runs out through Feilding and Foxton to the dunes and black-sand surf. Practically, the airport, the ranges, Feilding, the university and every suburb are within about twenty-five minutes.



A flat city on a wide plain, with the ranges on the horizon from almost every street

Summer

DEC – FEB

Warm, long and breezy, with daytime highs around 22–25°C. Students head home and the city settles into a relaxed holiday pace.

Autumn

MAR – MAY

Still and golden, around 17–21°C. Many locals' favourite season.

Winter

JUN – AUG

Crisp and frosty, around 11–13°C by day, with snow on the Tararua tops and plenty of bright, clear mornings.

Spring

SEP – NOV

Breezy, then lovely, around 14–19°C, with blossom and lambs on the plain and the westerly at its liveliest.

The wind is the local signature. The Manawatū sits in a gap between two ranges, which funnels the prevailing westerly across the plain; there is a wind farm above the gorge for a reason. Most days it is a breeze, and people arriving from Wellington think it calm. It is also drier than you would guess: the ranges take most of the rain.

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Warm homes: what to look for

The dry climate means mould is less of a worry here than in wetter regions; on a frosty plain, the thing to get right is warmth. Ask about insulation, double glazing and a heat pump, and check the Healthy Homes compliance statement, which landlords are legally required to provide.

Healthcare in Palmerston North

This is the part that changes people's minds. The clinical offer here is materially larger than the size of the city would suggest, and for some professions it is one of the more interesting places in the country to work.

Public hospital and specialist services are delivered by Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora. The hospital in the city is the base hospital for a large catchment: the Manawatū, Horowhenua, Tararua and out towards the Kāpiti coast. It carries acute medicine and surgery, an emergency department, maternity, paediatrics, intensive care, imaging and outpatients.

Around it sit community and district services, primary care, iwi and Māori health providers, and rural services reaching out to communities east of the ranges. Neurosurgery, cardiothoracics and the most complex paediatrics are referred south to Wellington, under two hours away.



The hospital's main entrance in Palmerston North, the base hospital for the wider region.

1 of a few

radiation oncology centres
in NZ

serving a region far wider
than the city

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base hospital

for Manawatū,
Horowhenua, Tararua and
towards Kāpiti

< 2 hrs

to the tertiary centre

in Wellington, for the most
complex work

The detail that makes this city unusual is the cancer centre. For radiation therapists, medical physicists, oncology nurses and medical imaging technologists, that means tertiary-level cancer work in a city where you can buy a house on one salary ten minutes from work. There are very few places in New Zealand where both are true at once.

It also makes for an unusually collegial service. A centre of this size delivering complex work produces clinicians who know each other's names across disciplines, and a lot of people tell us that is the part they come to value most.

CAPABLE GENERALISTS

Broad scope

Outside the tertiary centres you carry a wider caseload and make more of the decisions yourself.

TARARUA · HOROWHENUA · RANGITĪKEI

A large rural catchment

Outreach to rural communities, and work on health equity, are part of the daily picture and a real chance to make a difference.

VISIBILITY

Real progression

People move into senior and leadership roles here faster than they would in a large centre.

A WELCOMING TEAM

Skills that are valued

Like services across New Zealand, the hospital is growing its workforce, so skilled people are genuinely welcomed and quickly made part of the team.



Working with te ao Māori

This is the rohe of Rangitāne o Manawatū, with Ngāti Kahungunu, Muaūpoko, Ngāti Raukawa and others across the wider catchment. Expect karakia at the start of meetings, te reo on the ward, and whānau in the room and involved in decisions. Nobody expects you to arrive fluent; a genuine willingness to learn is what matters.



Colleagues on shift in Palmerston North: a service small enough that people know each other's names

What to ask at interview

- ☐ What is the catchment for my service, and how much rural or outreach work is involved?
- ☐ What is the on-call or rostered-hours pattern, and how is it paid under the relevant collective agreement?
- ☐ What gets referred to Wellington in my specialty, and how much of that pathway do I stay involved in?
- ☐ What orientation, supervision and cultural induction is there for clinicians new to New Zealand?
- ☐ Is there any link with the university for teaching, research or postgraduate study?

Where to live in Palmerston North

In most cities this choice is about balancing commute against cost. Here the commute is ten minutes from almost everywhere, so you get to choose on something better: what you want your street to feel like.

~10 MIN · RIVERSIDE

Hokowhitu

The city's most sought-after address. Leafy streets by the river and the Esplanade, established homes, well-regarded schools, and a walk to the water.

WALKABLE · CHARACTER

West End & Fitzroy

Villas and bungalows close to the centre, walkable to The Square and to work. Lovely character housing; ask about insulation and heating.

NORTH · FAMILY VALUE

Milson

Solid, friendly, good-value family housing, well served by schools and parks. A lot of people's first house here.

WEST · BEST VALUE

Awapuni & Takaro

Established suburbs with the best value inside the city boundary. Easy family living, five to ten minutes from anywhere.

NORTHERN EDGE · NEWER

Kelvin Grove

Newer, warm, well-insulated homes where the city is growing. More space for the money, and often cheaper to heat.

SOUTH OF THE RIVER

Fitzherbert

Between the river and the university. Green and mixed, with the He Ara Kotahi path into town.

~15 MIN · THE HILLS

Aokautere & Summerhill

Palmy's hill suburbs, with the views that come with them. Newer, larger homes and a favourite with relocating families.

20-30 MIN · TOWNS

Feilding, Ashhurst & Foxton

A country town with a famous Friday market, a village at the foot of the ranges, and the best-value housing in reach, by the coast.

Because the commute is so short, the nearby towns are a genuine option in their own right, with more house and more land for the money. Most clinicians we move here rent for six months and then buy, often years sooner than they could in a bigger city.



Settled in Palmerston North, with spring colour on the doorstep



Spring blossom, and room to enjoy it: one of the pleasures of a home with a garden

Three things to check before you sign

- ☐ Insulation, glazing and heating. Winters are frosty and many homes are older, so ask for the Healthy Homes compliance statement and look for a heat pump.
- ☐ The school zone, at the exact address. Popular state schools are zoned and enrolment is by address.
- ☐ Whether a nearby town suits you. Feilding or Ashhurst can stretch your money considerably further.

Getting around Palmerston North

Palmerston North is flat, compact and laid out on a grid. Work is an easy trip from every suburb: short drives, simple parking and flat streets made for cycling.

Ten to fifteen minutes by car from essentially anywhere, at any hour, with a mild thickening around school pick-up. Parking at the hospital and in town is straightforward and cheap or free. Arriving from London, Johannesburg, Dubai or Auckland, this is the change that surprises people most: an hour or more back every day.

It is also the best case for everyday cycling of any city we write about. It is almost entirely flat, distances are short, and there is a real network of shared paths, including He Ara Kotahi, the riverside path and bridge to the south bank and the university. A genuine proportion of the city cycles to work as a matter of course.



Clinicians tell us they get an hour or more back every day, and that the hour is worth more than they expected.

BEE CARD

City buses

A regional network across the city and out to Feilding and Ashhurst. Affordable and handy; check the timetable for your route.

WEEKDAYS

The commuter train

A service to Wellington. A relaxed alternative to driving, and it makes a day in the capital easy.

~10 MIN FROM THE CENTRE

The airport

Direct flights to Auckland, Wellington and Christchurch, and easy and quick to get through. Long-haul connects via Auckland or Wellington.

JOURNEY

TYPICAL TIME

Across the city

10–15 min

JOURNEY	TYPICAL TIME
City → airport	10 min
City → Feilding	20 min
City → Ashhurst / Te Āpiti	20–25 min
City → Foxton Beach	30 min
City → Wellington	1 hr 50
City → Napier or Taupō	~2 hr 30



Cycling on windy days

On a breezy day the westerly turns the ride home into a workout, so many regular riders keep an e-bike or a bus card for those days. Live centrally and one car per household is plenty.



Wellington, the capital, under two hours south by car or on the commuter train: an easy day out

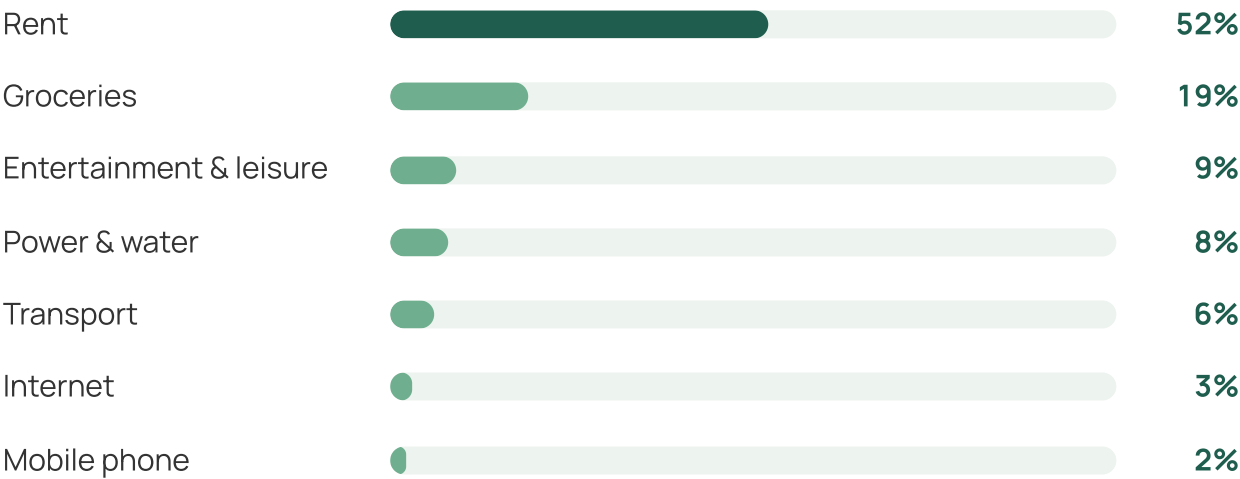
What it costs to live here

This is where Palmerston North really shines: the best housing value of any North Island city with a base hospital.

Clinical pay is national. You arrive on the same salary you would earn in Auckland, Tauranga or Wellington, into a housing market that costs a fraction of theirs. That is the entire proposition, and it is unusually clean.

A three or four-bedroom family home with a garden, in an established suburb and a decent school zone, ten minutes from the hospital, is an ordinary purchase on one clinical income here. In Tauranga or Auckland the same home usually takes two incomes or more. Go twenty minutes further and the numbers relax again.

Where a month goes



Proportions for one person on a mid-range budget, not amounts. Rent is the biggest line, and here it is the smallest in absolute terms of any North Island city with a base hospital.

The costs to plan for

- ✓ Winter heating. Frosty nights make a cosy, well-heated home worth prioritising; a warm house with a heat pump is worth paying a little more rent for.
- ✓ Getting home. Long-haul goes via Auckland or Wellington, so add the domestic leg or the drive.
- ✓ A car, but maybe only one. Most households run one car rather than two, a real annual saving people forget to count.
- ✓ Weekends away. Being central means you will travel more, because so much is within reach.



A garden of your own: on one clinical income, an ordinary part of family life here

IN SHORT

- ✓ On a clinical salary you will live comfortably and can buy a family home sooner than almost anywhere else in the North Island.
- ✓ Budget a little more for winter heating, and choose a warm house.
- ✓ Spend on insulation, not on postcode.



SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

What I tell people about Palmerston North

Palmerston North is often a lovely surprise: the city people discover once they start looking, and the one they thank me for afterwards. Complex cancer work in a city where you can buy a house on one salary, ten minutes from the hospital, is a combination that is rare anywhere in New Zealand.

What I tell people about the feel of the place is that it is green, friendly and practical, with a pace that leaves room for family. The beach is half an hour away, the snow is a weekend trip, and Wellington is close enough for a day out. If you want time, space and a home of your own, I will tell you to come and look.

Sophie Careem

Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing



Onam at home in Palmerston North, with friends who have become family



A weekend away together at Tongaporutu, on the Taranaki coast

Food, shopping and the everyday

The city eats well, and the university is a big part of the reason. Students and a research community make a market for good, affordable, varied food.

THE DINING LANE

George Street

A genuinely good strip of small restaurants and bars a minute from The Square, and the answer when someone asks where to go.

EVERYDAY

Broadway & The Square

Cafés, bakeries and bistros around the green centre. Lunch and coffee territory.

EAT WIDELY

Student value

Asian, Indian, Middle Eastern and Pacific food at student-friendly prices.

TAKE IT SERIOUSLY

Coffee

Local roasters, and a suburban café flat white that will beat most British cities' best.

The Manawatū is a farming plain, and the food culture follows from it. The Saturday farmers' market in the city is the weekend fixture: produce, meat, bread, cheese, coffee and half the neighbourhood. Twenty minutes north, Feilding has a famous Friday market and working saleyards.

For specialist ingredients, the student population is your ally: there is a great range of Asian, Indian and halal grocers. If a particular cuisine is central to how your family eats, ask us and we will point you to the right shops, and Wellington is close for anything more specialised.



Te Manawa, the city's museum, art gallery and science centre in one building

The rhythm of the week

- ✓ Term time and summer have different moods. In term the place hums; from December to February it settles into a relaxed summer pace. Locals love both.
- ✓ Sport is the social glue. Rugby, netball, cycling, hockey, football, running and cricket; joining a club is the fastest way to know people.
- ✓ Evenings and Sundays are relaxed. Most shops close around 5.30 or 6pm, leaving evenings for home, and Sundays are for markets, sport and family time.

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Worth planning for

For a big shopping trip, the latest touring concert or a major exhibition, Wellington makes an easy day out. Groceries across New Zealand can cost more than people expect coming from Britain or Australia, so the Saturday market and seasonal produce are worth getting to know.

What people do at the weekend

Weekends here are outdoors, local and easy: mountains twenty-five minutes one way, coast half an hour the other, a river through the middle, and enough time left over for sport, markets and friends.

The Manawatū runs along the southern edge of the city, and the path network beside it is what residents use most. He Ara Kotahi links the city to the south bank, the university and a long, flat loop that works equally well for a run, a ride or a pram.

Next to it is the Victoria Esplanade: riverside gardens, a rose collection, an aviary, a playground and a miniature railway. Simple and entirely lovely. If you arrive with children it will become a fixture within a fortnight.

A typical Palmy weekend

- ✓ Saturday morning at the farmers' market for produce, bread and coffee, then club sport: rugby, netball, football, hockey and cricket for every age.
- ✓ A walk, run or bike ride on He Ara Kotahi and the river paths, or a picnic at the Esplanade.
- ✓ An afternoon in the bush at Te Āpiti, the Sledge Track or Arapuke Forest Park.
- ✓ In summer, a drive to Foxton Beach or Himatangi for a swim, fish and chips and a long walk on the sand.
- ✓ Te Manawa, the Lido pools and the library when it rains, and festivals, night markets and community events across the year.
- ✓ Friday's market in Feilding, or a day in Wellington with time for Te Papa or Zealandia.

~15 MIN

Arapuke Forest Park

Purpose-built mountain biking in pine and native forest, graded from first-timer to serious.

~25 MIN

Te Āpiti / Manawatū Gorge

Tracks through native bush, a ridgeline route and a lookout among the wind turbines. The region's signature day out.

NEAR ASHHURST

The Sledge Track

A short, popular bush walk with swing bridges. The go-to when you have an hour and a half.

~ 30 MIN

The Manawatū coast

Thirty kilometres of dunes, marram, driftwood and black sand at Himatangi and Foxton Beach.



Dunes, marram and big skies: the character of the coast half an hour west

NORTH-EAST

Rangiwāhia, Ruahine

A beautiful half-day into bush and open tops, crossing an arched bridge over a gorge.



Carving and story in the bush, across the rohe of Rangitāne



The arched bridge on the Rangiwāhia Track in the Ruahine

Easy trips from Palmerston North

Living in the middle of the lower North Island means a great deal is an easy drive away: the capital, the beaches, the volcanoes and ski fields, and some of the country's best-known walks.

Wellington is about two hours south by road, or a relaxed trip on the train. It makes an easy day out or a weekend: Te Papa, the national museum, the waterfront and its cafés, theatre and concerts, and Zealandia, the fenced eco-sanctuary in a city valley where native birds such as kākā and takahē thrive, with guided night tours to see kiwi.

North, the road climbs to the volcanic plateau. Mount Ruapehu's ski fields, the Tongariro Alpine Crossing and Lake Taupō are all within about two to two and a half hours, which makes a snow weekend in winter an ordinary thing to do. Whanganui, a river city with galleries and heritage streets, is just over an hour north-west.

Closer still, the beaches at Foxton Beach and Himatangi are half an hour west, Te Āpiti and the gorge tracks twenty-five minutes east, and Feilding and Ashhurst twenty minutes away. Many families find this the real gift of the city: home life is easy, and something different is always a short drive away.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Foxton Beach & Himatangi Beach	about 30 min	The nearest beaches: black sand, surf and big skies. Summer swims, fishing and long walks; check conditions and swim where it is patrolled.
Kāpiti Coast	~1 hr 15	Long beaches, seaside villages and boat trips to the Kāpiti Island nature reserve.
Ruapehu ski fields (Tūroa & Whakapapa)	~2–2 hrs 30	The North Island's main ski fields, with a season of roughly June to October, snow permitting.
Wellington	~2 hrs	The capital: Zealandia, Te Papa, the waterfront, shows and the ferry to the South Island.
Palmerston North Airport	about 10 min	Direct domestic flights; international connections via Auckland or Wellington.
Te Āpiti / Manawatū Gorge	~25 min	Bush tracks, a lookout among the wind turbines and the region's signature walk.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Whanganui	~1 hr 15	A river city with an arts scene, heritage architecture and the Whanganui River.
Tongariro National Park	~2 hrs 30	The Tongariro Alpine Crossing, volcanoes and lakes; a classic summer adventure.

~2 HRS · WELLINGTON

Zealandia

A predator-free valley of regenerating forest minutes from central Wellington, full of native birds. The night tour, with a chance to see kiwi in the wild, is unforgettable.

~2 HRS · WELLINGTON

Te Papa & the waterfront

The national museum, hands-on and huge, beside a waterfront walk lined with cafés. A favourite rainy-day trip with children.

~2-2 HRS 30

Snow on Ruapehu

Learn to ski or snowboard, ride the chairlifts, or simply play in the snow for the day. Many local families make it an annual winter trip.

~2 HRS 30

Tongariro Alpine Crossing

New Zealand's best-known day walk, past steaming vents and emerald lakes. Go in summer, with a guide or a good forecast.

~1 HR 15

Whanganui

Galleries, glass studios, heritage streets and the river. An easy day trip with lunch included.

~1 HR 15

Kāpiti Coast

Beaches, cafés and village life, with day trips to Kāpiti Island to see rare native birds.

~2 HRS 30

Hawke's Bay

Art deco Napier, vineyards and warm, dry summers over the ranges to the east.

~3 HRS

Taranaki

A near-perfect volcanic cone, the coastal walkway in New Plymouth and the surf coast. A great long weekend.



Regenerating bush at Zealandia, Wellington's eco-sanctuary, about two hours south



Whakapapa, on Mount Ruapehu: about two and a half hours away, and an ordinary winter weekend for one of the families we helped move



Oriental Bay in Wellington: a day out in the capital is an easy trip



Taranaki Maunga: the Taranaki coast and mountain make a great long weekend



Te Mata Peak in Hawke's Bay, over the ranges for wine, beaches and Art Deco Napier

A good city to grow up in

Is it a good place with children? Very much so, and it is why a lot of clinical families end up here: space, short commutes, safe streets, sport everywhere, and enough left at the end of the month to actually do things.



Papaioea Park: open green space is never far away in Palmy



A family festival in Palmerston North: the city runs plenty of these, and they are often where newcomers first meet people

The city runs the full range of schooling, from kindergartens and early childhood centres to a university. New Zealand children usually start school at five; primary runs from Year 1 to Year 8 (some cities split off intermediate schools for Years 7 and 8), and secondary from Year 9 to Year 13, across four terms a year.

Most children attend free state schools. Alongside them are state-integrated schools, many of them Catholic or Christian, which follow the national curriculum and charge attendance dues, and a number of independent schools. There are also kura kaupapa Māori and bilingual units teaching in te reo Māori.

Long-established secondary options include Palmerston North Boys' High School and Palmerston North Girls' High School, alongside co-educational state and integrated colleges across the city. Schools here are known for strong sport, music and cultural programmes, and for being closely involved in their communities.

Choosing a school

- ☐ Check the enrolment zone at the exact address before you sign a lease. Popular state schools run enrolment schemes, and living in zone guarantees a place.
- ☐ Read the school's report from the Education Review Office at ero.govt.nz. ERO reviews every school and early childhood service, and the reports are written for parents.
- ☐ Visit, or ask for a video call. Principals here are used to international families and are generally happy to talk.
- ☐ Ask about support for children new to New Zealand, including English language help where it is needed.

What children tend to love here

- ✓ The Victoria Esplanade: playground, gardens, the miniature railway, and Wildbase Recovery, where injured native birds are cared for.
- ✓ The city library, with storytelling sessions and children's activities.
- ✓ Club sport and activities for every age, from rippa rugby and netball to swimming, dance and music.
- ✓ The Lido Aquatic Centre, with indoor and outdoor pools, hydrosides and swimming lessons.
- ✓ Te Manawa's hands-on science centre and museum.
- ✓ Learning to ride on flat streets and shared river paths.

It is a more international city than many expect, thanks to Massey and to a health workforce that has welcomed overseas clinicians for years. There are established Indian, Filipino and Pacific communities and places of worship across faiths, and you will find other international clinicians on your ward. If a particular community, faith or language matters to you, ask us and we will help you find it.

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Early childhood

New Zealand funds up to 20 hours a week of early childhood education ("20 Hours ECE") for three to five-year-olds at participating kindergartens and centres. Many follow Te Whāriki, the national early childhood curriculum built around learning through play.



Dressed up for a celebration at home: families keep their festivals going here



Weekend beach walks: an easy, free family outing

MANAWATŪ CAMPUS

Massey University

The main campus sits just south of the river, known for veterinary science, agriculture, science and business, and a large part of the city's life.

REGIONAL POLYTECHNIC

UCOL

Vocational and professional study, including health programmes, close to the city centre.

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**Palmy suits clinicians doing the maths,
and keeps them for everything else.**

Your Palmerston North address book

Palmerston North has one of the most established Kerala communities in regional New Zealand, centred on the Kerala Association of Palmerston North (KAPN), which has been running Onam, Christmas and sports events since 2010. Around it sit an active Indian association, a Sikh gurdwara, a mosque and a multicultural council with more than 60 member community groups.

COUNCILS

Palmerston North City Council

Rubbish days, libraries, pools, parks, dog registration and city events

pncc.govt.nz

Manawatū District Council

Feilding and the rural district around it

mdc.govt.nz

Horizons Regional Council

Regional council for Manawatū-Whanganui, including the local bus network

horizons.govt.nz

GETTING TO KNOW THE PLACE

Manawatū NZ

The region's official visitor site: events, food, trails and things to do

manawatunz.co.nz

Te Manawa

The city's museum, art gallery and science centre in one building

temanawa.co.nz

Massey University

The university that shapes the city's calendar, sport and public events

massey.ac.nz

COMMUNITY & CULTURAL ASSOCIATIONS

Kerala Association of Palmerston North (KAPN)

The Malayali association for Palmerston North and Manawatū: Onam (Ponnonam), Christmas, the Suvarnasandhya cultural night, community games and a football tournament; open membership.

kapn.co.nz

Central Districts Indian Association (CDIA)

Indian cultural association for Manawatū, Hawke's Bay and Whanganui; runs Diwali, Navratri and Ganesh Chaturthi events.

cdia.org.nz

Diwali Mela, Te Marae o Hine / The Square

Free family Diwali festival in the city centre each November, run with the council.

pncc.govt.nz/News-Events/Events/Diwali-Mela

Manawatū Multicultural Council (MMC)

Umbrella body for more than 60 community groups; settlement help, interpreting and the annual Festival of Cultures. Based at Hancock Community House, 77–85 King Street.

06 358 1572 mmcnz.org.nz

MMC Community Connector drop-in

Free drop-in advice for newcomers at Te Āhuru Mōwai, third Monday of each month, 10am to 1pm.

Philippines Central Association

Filipino community group for the Manawatū; a member of the Manawatū Multicultural Council.

South African Community in Palmerston North

South African community group; a member of the Manawatū Multicultural Council.

New Zealand Chinese Association – Manawātū

Chinese community association: Lunar New Year and other cultural events.

facebook.com/NZCAManawatu

Manawatu Bangalee Society

Bengali community group; a member of the Manawātū Multicultural Council.

English Language Partners – Palmerston North

Free and low-cost English classes, conversation groups and home tutoring for adults and partners. Level 1, 44 King Street.

06 359 2332

englishlanguage.org.nz/centres/palmerston-north

Citizens Advice Bureau Palmerston North

Free, confidential advice for anyone (not just citizens) on tenancy, work, money and services. 77–85 King Street.

06 357 0647 cab.org.nz

Network of Skilled Migrants Manawātū

Networking group for migrants looking for work and professional contacts.

facebook.com/skilledmigrantsnetwork

PNCC Welcoming Communities

The city council's newcomer programme, with a downloadable Palmy welcome pack.

pncc.govt.nz/Community/Community-projects-and-programmes/Welcoming-Communities

FACEBOOK & ONLINE GROUPS

KAPN on Facebook

Where the Kerala Association posts event dates, Onam tickets and community notices.

facebook.com/kapn2010

CDIA on Facebook

Central Districts Indian Association updates and festival announcements.

facebook.com/profile.php?id=100094236826573

Manawatu Multicultural Council Palmerston North

MMC news, Festival of Cultures and community notices.

facebook.com/mmcnzpn

Manawatu Muslims Association

Mosque notices, Ramadan and Eid timings.

facebook.com/manawatumuslimsassociation

Palmy & Manawātū

The region's official page for events and what's on.

facebook.com/ManawatuNZ

PLACES OF WORSHIP

Cathedral of the Holy Spirit (Catholic)

The city's main Catholic church, 197 Broadway Avenue; Sunday Masses morning and evening.

06 357 2891 pncathedral.org.nz

St Mary's Catholic Church, Ruahine Street

Catholic parish with many Kerala families. Syro-Malabar (Malayalam) Qurbana runs once or twice a month in the diocese; ask the parish office for dates.

06 358 5614

Our Lady of Lourdes (Catholic)

Catholic parish at 96 Shamrock Street; Saturday vigil and Sunday morning Mass.

06 358 3667

All Saints Anglican Church

Central Anglican parish, 338 Church Street.

06 358 2203

Life Church

Large Pentecostal-style church, 590 Featherston Street, Roslyn.

06 356 2525

Assembly of God, Takaro

Pentecostal congregation at 27 Matipo Street, Takaro.

06 356 9913

Manawatu Muslims Association mosque

The city's mosque at 81 Cook Street; Qur'an classes, marriage and funeral services, free shuttle to the masjid.

06 357 8362 manawatumuslims.org.nz

Gurudwara Shri Fateh Sahib (Palmerston North Sikh Society)

Gurdwara on Botanical Road; weekly diwan with langar, and Gurmukhi and kirtan classes.

06 359 0057 pnsikhsociety.org

New Zealand Sikh Society (Palmerston North)

Second Sikh society running gurdwara services for the Manawatū.

06 355 1987

Hindu festivals via CDIA

No standalone Hindu temple was confirmed; CDIA hosts Navratri, Ganesh Chaturthi and Diwali pujas.

cdia.org.nz

Manawatu Buddhist Cambodian Society

Buddhist community group; a member of the Manawatū Multicultural Council.

HALAL, KOSHER & INTERNATIONAL GROCERIES

Hana Mart Asian Grocery

Asian grocer at 199 Cuba Street.

06 355 3979

Tastes of the UK

British groceries and treats, 73 Milson Line, Milson.

06 353 5397

Halal meat: ask at the mosque

The Manawatu Muslims Association can point you to current halal butchers and certified products.

manawatumuslims.org.nz

FIANZ halal certification list

National list of halal-certified NZ brands, useful for supermarket shopping.

fianz.com

Kosher food

No kosher shop locally; families order from Wellington or Auckland or online. The Wellington Jewish Community Centre can advise.

wjcc.org.nz

SUPERMARKETS & MARKETS

PAK'nSAVE Palmerston North

Large discount supermarket at 335 Ferguson Street.

paknsave.co.nz

New World

Stores including Ruapehu Drive, Fitzherbert, south of the river.

newworld.co.nz

Woolworths (formerly Countdown)

Several stores, including Featherston Street, Main Street and Fernlea Avenue.

woolworths.co.nz

Four Square

Small local grocers in Awapuni, Highbury, Cloverlea and Ashhurst.

foursquare.co.nz

Hokowhitu Village Farmers' Market

First and third Sunday of each month, 9am to 1pm, Albert Street: local produce, street food and live music.

Feilding Farmers' Market

Award-winning market every Friday, 9am to 1.30pm, Manchester Square, Feilding (20 minutes north).

Highbury Flea Market

Every Sunday, 7am to 1pm, Highbury Shopping Centre car park: fresh produce and food.

Markets listing

Up-to-date list of Manawatū markets and seasonal fairs.

manawatunz.co.nz/explore/shop/markets

SCHOOLS, UNIFORMS & FAMILIES

Find a school / school zones

Check which state schools are zoned for an exact address.

educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

NZ Uniforms – Palmerston North

National uniform retailer with a Palmerston North store; also check your school's own uniform shop and PTA second-hand sales.

nzuniforms.com/pages/store-locator.htm

Plunket Palmerston North Family Centre

Free parenting support and checks for under-5s, 42 Albert Street. PlunketLine is free on 0800 933 922.

plunket.org.nz

Palmerston North City Library

Central library on The Square plus branches and a mobile library bus; free Wi-Fi, multilingual collections and children's sessions.

citylibrary.pncc.govt.nz

Sport Manawātū

Find sports clubs and activities for children and adults.

sportmanawatu.org.nz

HOUSING & AREAS

Trade Me Property – Palmerston North

Main rental and sale listings site.

trademe.co.nz/a/property/residential/rent/manawatu-whanganui/palmerston-north

realestate.co.nz

Sale and rental listings from local agencies.

realestate.co.nz

Tenancy Services market rent tool

Check what rents in a suburb actually go for before you offer.

tenancy.govt.nz/rent-bond-and-bills/market-rent

PNCC property and rates search

Look up the rates and property details for any address.

pncc.govt.nz/Rates-Building-Property/Property-housing/Property-and-rates-search

Housing Advice Centre

Free tenant-rights information, King Street.

Trade Me Flatmates

Rooms and flatshares while you find a house.

trademe.co.nz/a/flatmates-wanted

GETTING AROUND

Connect (Horizons Regional Council buses)

City routes, Massey University buses and links to Feilding, Ashhurst, Levin and Whanganui; journey planner and live tracking.

0508 800 800 goconnect.org.nz

Bee Card

The bus fare card used across Manawātū-Whanganui (and Waikato and Bay of Plenty).

beecard.co.nz

Capital Connection

Weekday commuter train between Palmerston North and Wellington.

Palmerston North Airport

Ten minutes from the centre, with direct flights to Auckland, Wellington and Christchurch.

pnairport.co.nz

InterCity

Long-distance coaches to Wellington, Auckland, Napier and beyond.

intercity.co.nz

NZTA driver licences

Converting an overseas licence and finding a licensing agent.

nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences

COST OF LIVING COMPARISONS

Numbeo – Palmerston North

Crowd-sourced prices to compare with your current city.

numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Palmerston-North

Expatistan – Palmerston North

Second crowd-sourced comparison, including a family estimate.

expatistan.com/cost-of-living/palmerston-north

Tenancy Services market rent

Official recent rents by suburb and house size.

tenancy.govt.nz/rent-bond-and-bills/market-rent

Powerswitch

Free comparison of power and broadband plans for your address.

powerswitch.org.nz

Sorted budget planner

Free government-backed budgeting tools.

sorted.org.nz

Stats NZ

Official price, rent and wage statistics.

stats.govt.nz



Checked October 2026

Community groups, shops and pages change. If a link has moved or you know a group we should add, tell us and we will update the guide.

Numbers and websites to keep handy

The national services every newcomer uses, wherever in New Zealand you land.

EMERGENCIES & HEALTH ADVICE

Emergency services

Police, fire and ambulance, any time

111

Healthline

Free 24/7 health advice from a nurse, in any language

0800 611 116

Need to talk?

Free call or text a trained counsellor, 24/7

1737

National Poisons Centre

24/7 advice if someone may have been poisoned

0800 764 766

PlunketLine

Free 24/7 support for parents of under-fives

0800 933 922

VISAS, REGISTRATION & WORK

Immigration New Zealand

Visas, the Green List and residence pathways

immigration.govt.nz

Immigration Advisers Authority

Check an adviser is licensed before you pay

iaa.govt.nz

Responsible authorities

The registration board for every regulated health profession

health.govt.nz/regulated-health-professions

Nursing Council of New Zealand

Registration for nurses

nursingcouncil.org.nz

Medical Council of New Zealand

Registration for doctors

mcnz.org.nz

HEALTHCARE FOR YOUR FAMILY

Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora

How public healthcare works and who is eligible

tewhatuora.govt.nz

Healthpoint

Find a GP, pharmacy, dentist or urgent care near you

healthpoint.co.nz

ACC

Accident cover for everyone in New Zealand, including visitors

acc.co.nz

SCHOOLS & CHILDCARE

Find a school

Every school, with its enrolment zone

educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

Education Review Office

Independent reports on schools and early learning

ero.govt.nz

Parents and whānau

How schooling, early childhood education and fees work

parents.education.govt.nz

MONEY, HOME & GETTING AROUND

Inland Revenue (IRD)

Your IRD number, tax and KiwiSaver
ird.govt.nz

Tenancy Services

Renting rules, bonds and market rents by area
tenancy.govt.nz

NZ Transport Agency

Converting your overseas driver licence
nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences

Powerswitch

Compare power companies in your area
powerswitch.org.nz

Sorted

Free, independent budgeting tools
sorted.org.nz

MPI · pets

Bringing cats and dogs into New Zealand
mpi.govt.nz/bring-send-to-nz/pets-travelling-to-nz

SETTLING IN

Citizens Advice Bureau

Free, confidential help with almost any question
0800 367 222 cab.org.nz

Ministry for Ethnic Communities

Support and connections for new migrant communities
ethniccommunities.govt.nz

Department of Conservation

Huts, tracks, campsites and Great Walks bookings
doc.govt.nz



Always check the source

Rules, fees and services change. Treat these as starting points and confirm details with the organisation. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not licensed immigration advisers.

Six steps, and someone beside you for each one

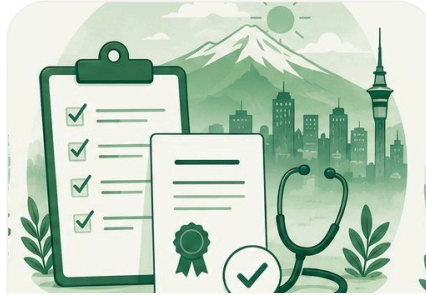
Moving country is a sequence of decisions. We take them with you in order, so you are never solving step five before step two is done.



STEP 1

Discovery call

A relaxed conversation about your profession, your family and what you want from a move. No forms, no pressure.



STEP 2

Eligibility & registration

We map your route to New Zealand registration and help you gather the evidence the regulator will ask for.



STEP 3

Opportunities & interviews

Roles matched to where you want to live and how you like to work, with honest briefings before every interview.



STEP 4

Offer & decision support

We help you read the offer properly: pay step, relocation support, roster and what the team is really like.



STEP 5

Visa & relocation guidance

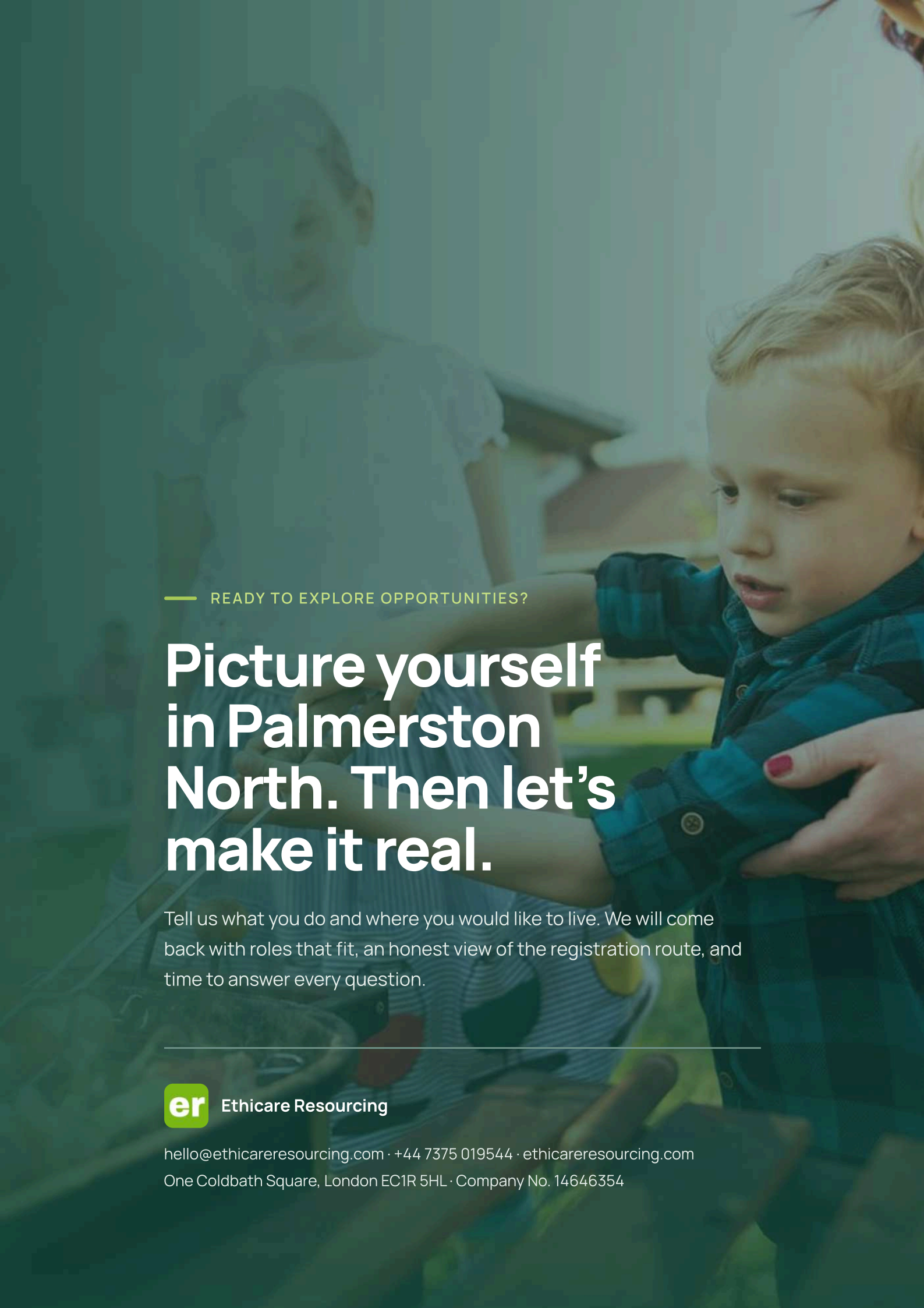
Practical guidance on visas, shipping, pets, schools and the first weeks, so nothing arrives as a surprise.



STEP 6

Settling in

We stay in touch after you land, from your first week on the ward to your first winter.

A woman with blonde hair is holding a young child with blonde hair in a garden. The child is wearing a blue and black plaid shirt. The woman is wearing a white top. They are standing in front of a house with a red roof. The background is slightly blurred.

— READY TO EXPLORE OPPORTUNITIES?

Picture yourself in Palmerston North. Then let's make it real.

Tell us what you do and where you would like to live. We will come back with roles that fit, an honest view of the registration route, and time to answer every question.



Ethicare Resourcing

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